

Planning to Thrive

How can we set and achieve personal goals to help us thrive?

Grades

6-8

Subjects

Health/PE

Estimated Duration

12-18 instructional
hours*

Key Content

mental and physical
health, nutrition,
physical activity,
sleep, stress
management



Students set personal health goals, craft “Healthy Mind and Body” action plans, and put them into practice, tracking their progress and documenting their reflections in a journal. Teams develop and support action plans for clients and consolidate their learning into a best practices guidebook for setting and achieving personal health goals which they distribute at a community health fair and/or publish online as an ebook or website.

The pacing for this project may vary greatly depending on the length of time allotted for students and clients to work on and track their health goals. Once that phase of the project is complete, you can resume with the remaining milestones.

Project Path

Project Launch

How can people meet their goals for improving their health?

Entry Event: Low-stakes writing: reflection on students’ current health and personal health goals followed by a review of client profiles

Build Knowledge and Develop & Critique

How can we set appropriate mental and physical health goals for ourselves and our clients?

Form teams and prepare for effective collaboration.

Engage in jigsaw activity to build background knowledge about mental and physical health and learn ways to set and meet achievable health goals for themselves and their clients.

How can we craft action plans that will set ourselves and our clients up for success?

Develop and track progress on “Healthy Mind and Body” plans for achieving personal health goals and design and present “Healthy Mind and Body” action plans for clients.

How can we share what we’ve learned with others who want to achieve their own health goals?

Create, critique, and revise best practice articles for helping others achieve their health goals and create displays and materials for distribution at the health fair.

Present Products

How can we engage the community in learning about best practices for achieving health goals?

Host a community health fair to showcase a published best practices ebook (resource guide) for achieving health goals and gather feedback from attendees and online audience.

Make It Yours

Reflect on your students

- How can you ensure that this project is affirming, body-positive, and accessible for all students, regardless of body type, size, or physical ability? How will you redirect or reframe the project, if necessary, to maintain this focus?
- How can you engage students in a discussion of the ways that culture and social conditioning influence our ideas of what a “healthy” body looks like and what it can do?
- What ideas, experiences, preconceptions, or values related to health and/or goal setting are students bringing into this project? How can you learn more about students’ current beliefs and activities?
- How can you use this project to build on health-centered practices in which students and community members are already engaging?
- What interests do students have that could inform the kinds of healthy practices that they choose to adopt? For example, do students in your class like nature, games, arts, and so on? How could this inform the types of activities they choose?
- Are there multiple language skills or cultural backgrounds in your class? If so, are there opportunities for students to leverage these skills as they work with clients or prepare the guide?

Reflect on your context

- What kinds of physical activities are possible for students given the environment in your school? For example, is there space to safely run or walk outside in the mornings or evenings? How accessible is fresh and healthy food? Do students have access to the school gym or schoolyard outside of class?
- How will you identify and prepare clients for students to consult with during this project?
- Are there local organizations (such as a senior center, YMCA, Boys and Girls Club, recreation department, or community health organization) that might serve as community partners or help locate a public audience for this work?
- What technological tools are available for students to track their progress on goals and document their reflections?

Reflect on the content & skills

- How will you help students learn about basic nutrition, balanced physical activity (including an awareness of FITT: frequency, intensity, time, and type), and strategies for managing stress? What resources, scaffolds, and activities might help to build this knowledge?
- What scaffolds might be helpful to students as they write their journals and their guides? How will you support students who struggle with literacy skills?
- What specific collaboration or communication skills might you want to teach and assess through this project? How will you scaffold these skills?

Take It Further

Here are some ideas for expanding this project if you choose to do so:

- Partner with a senior center, YMCA, Boys and Girls Club, recreation department, or community health center to connect with clients beyond the school community.
- Have clients share short videos introducing themselves to the class or meet with students in real time (in person or via video conferencing).
 - Have students interview clients (<https://my.pblworks.org/resource/preparing-interviews>), asking them to reflect on current habits and share additional information (e.g. current dietary and sleeping habits, types and levels of physical activity, preferences/interests, and any individual needs, physical limitations, or logistical considerations) that will help students develop achievable goals and action plans for their clients. Have students practice interviewing each other to refine their interviewing skills and develop empathy for the clients being interviewed. Note: If scheduling interviews presents a challenge, students can email interview questions for clients to respond in writing.
- Have students meet with clients in person or virtually to present their “Healthy Mind and Body” plans, explaining the rationale behind their action plan design and showing clients how to use the habit trackers to measure and self-assess their progress. This could potentially include allowing for client feedback and input into the final plan for achieving their health goals. Students can also set-up a schedule of periodic check-ins with their clients to monitor their progress.
- Have students complete a fitness test, such as the FitnessGram (<https://fitnessgram.net>) or the Presidential Youth Fitness Program (<https://www.pyfp.org>), and use that data to inform their own health goals. See these recommendations from the CDC (https://www.cdc.gov/healthyschools/physicalactivity/pdf/2014_09_12_14-249482-nihiser-collectingfitnessdata-final-508web_tag508_2.pdf), determine what accommodations or modifications you may need to provide individual students, and be sure to frame the test so that it is not competitive.
- Teach students about the FITT framework for balanced physical activity: Frequency, Intensity, Time, and Type.
- Guide students in learning how to set health goals and monitor progress in ways that are supportive, affirming and body-positive. Discuss the Health at Every Size movement (<https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/health-every-size>), and explore the research around it.
- Have students learn about food deserts (<https://www.worldsavvy.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/06/Food-Deserts.pdf>) and food insecurity to deepen their understanding of how structural factors can present challenges when people are trying to maintain a healthy lifestyle.
- To enhance the online publication of the resource guides, have students develop infographics, interactive web pages, videos, apps, and/or other multimedia products for

sharing their information.

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